03 | RESOURCE | UNDERSTAND THE TOOL

Choose priorities with purpose

Use the chart with your actual responsibilities and decision authority.

Urgency is about time and the effect of delay. Importance is about the result: required work, service, safety, and agreed goals. A request can feel urgent without being the best use of your time.

	URGENT	NOT URGENT
IMPORTANT	**Q1 • ACT NOW** Address a real service risk or deadline now. Use the correct authority.	**Q2 • SCHEDULE** Protect time for prevention, planning, learning, and required work before it becomes urgent.
NOT IMPORTANT	**Q3 • CHECK & ROUTE** Verify the demand. Route, delegate, or renegotiate only within your authority.	**Q4 • REDUCE OR STOP** Reduce work with no useful purpose after checking that it is not required.

Define importance through your role

Start with your job responsibilities, the branch RACI, current procedures, and expectations set by your supervisor. The seniority of the requester does not replace checking the actual service need or deadline.

Use Office Hours and protected work time

Bring nonurgent questions to the published support or Office Hours schedule when appropriate. Use protected focus time to complete important work, process requests, and send replies. Urgent service or safety issues use the required route without waiting for Office Hours.

> **Avoid these two shortcuts**
> Q3 does not mean hand every urgent task to someone else. Q4 does not mean delete a required duty. Check the need and your authority before changing or stopping work.

Training basis: Time Management in a CLEAR Way, final workshop. Model context: FranklinCovey, Choice 1.

Learn more: FranklinCovey model context

03 | RESOURCE | PUT IT TO WORK

Move from a chart to a plan

Illustrative examples. Your actual facts and role may change the quadrant.

Example	Quadrant	Useful next action
Coverage is missing before the next required service window.	Q1	Act through the correct route to address the immediate service risk.
Repeated confusion could be prevented with a clearer job aid.	Q2	Schedule time to prepare the update and obtain any required review.
An optional font change is requested by noon; it does not affect the work.	Q3	Verify the deadline and purpose. Renegotiate or route it within authority.
An optional flyer for a canceled event is still being polished.	Q4	Confirm there is no remaining requirement, then stop or reduce the work.

Plan one important task

Use this space	Your notes
Task and reason	
Deadline / protected time	
Quadrant / action / owner	
What finished looks like	

Review the result

Did the protected time happen? What interrupted it? Did the task prevent repeat questions, reduce rework, or improve service? Adjust the plan without losing the purpose of the work.

Make the next step visible

"I will complete _____ during _____. The result will be _____. I need _____ confirmed by _____."

Training basis: Time Management in a CLEAR Way, final workshop. Model context: FranklinCovey, Choice 1.